

Right The regular line outside the famous Magpie Café fish-and-chips restaurant in Whitby, North Yorkshire

Below Crisply battered cod and piping-hot chips are accompanied by the traditional northern garnish, mushy peas



A Day in Whitby

Most visits to Whitby are divided between the cobbled old town and the beach. It's only a small place (population around 15,000), but it makes a great base for exploring the nearby smugglers' villages and coastal cliff-top paths and also the North York Moors National Park.

MORNING Make an early visit (by 7:00 AM) to the **fish market**, and then stroll along the harbor for a view of town from the long, curving pier. Cross the river by the swing bridge to explore the **old town** on the east side – including the **Captain Cook Memorial Museum** – before climbing the 199 steps to the dramatic ruins of **Whitby Abbey**.

AFTERNOON Even if the beach beckons, don't miss **Whitby Museum** and its amazing collection of Jurassic period fossils. Fang-fans can also follow the **Dracula trail** around town – Bram Stoker set his famous novel here.

EVENING Walk up to the **Captain Cook Monument** to join an early evening guided "ghost walk" around the town's hidden alleys and lanes, before choosing a fish and seafood restaurant for dinner.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Whitby is on England's northeastern coast, an hour's **drive** (or **bus ride**) from York. York lies on the East Coast **train** line between London and Edinburgh; there are also direct **trains** to York from **Manchester International Airport**. A **steam railroad** runs to nearby Pickering.

WHERE TO STAY

Dillons (inexpensive) has classy, contemporary B&B rooms. www.dillonsofwhitby.co.uk
White Horse & Griffin (moderate) is a stylishly updated coaching inn and restaurant. www.whitehorseandgriffin.co.uk

La Rosa (expensive) offers quirky, vintage Victorian surroundings. www.larosa.co.uk

TOURIST INFORMATION

Whitby Tourist Information Centre, Langborne Road; www.discoveryyorkshirecoast.com

